The station also maintained a clandestine, paramilitary army and navy, training posts and bases, boats, and weapons, paying salaries and providing logistics. One agent claimed that he went on almost weekly missions on the CIA payroll during this period, including "large-scale raids aimed at blowing up oil refineries and chemical plants" as well as dropping off and picking up "teams" of agents along the Cuban coast.[54] Another described missions including attacks on a Texaco oil refinery, factories, and Russian ships docked in Cuban harbors. In one mission, a seven-man team blew up a railroad bridge and watched a train run off the track, and burned down a sugar warehouse.[55]

The U.S. defeat at the Bay of Pigs also led to the establishment of Operation MONGOOSE. Unlike the CIA, which was *supposed* to keep its operations hidden from government officials in order to maintain "plausible deniability," MONGOOSE would be overseen by a newly created Special Group (Augmented) which included Kennedy's top advisors.[56] General Edward Landsdale oversaw Operation MONGOOSE, an administratively separate operation for sabotage and subversion, which accelerated in the summer and fall of 1962. In August of that year the Special Group (Augmented) debated an all-out effort to overthrow Castro, but decided that this "would hurt the U.S. in the eyes of world opinion." General Taylor suggested "that we should consider changing the overall objective from one of overthrowing the Castro regime to one of causing its failure" through economic sabotage.[57] Robert McNamara agreed that the time had come "to take every possible aggressive step in the fields of intelligence, sabotage, and guerrilla action"; by the end of the month, Kennedy's advisors had approved the major attack on Cuba's Matahambre copper mine.[58]

In August 1962 the Cuban exile organization Alpha 66 conducted a raid against a coastal hotel "where Soviet military technicians were known to congregate, killing a score of Russians and Cubans. Although this particular raid was apparently not sanctioned by the United States," Raymond Garthoff explained, Alpha 66 "was permitted to base itself in Florida." In September a new phase of MONGOOSE began, "calling for more raids into Cuba." Alpha 66 carried out two more raids on